

Dire Beginnings

Questbook B:
The Mother of Want

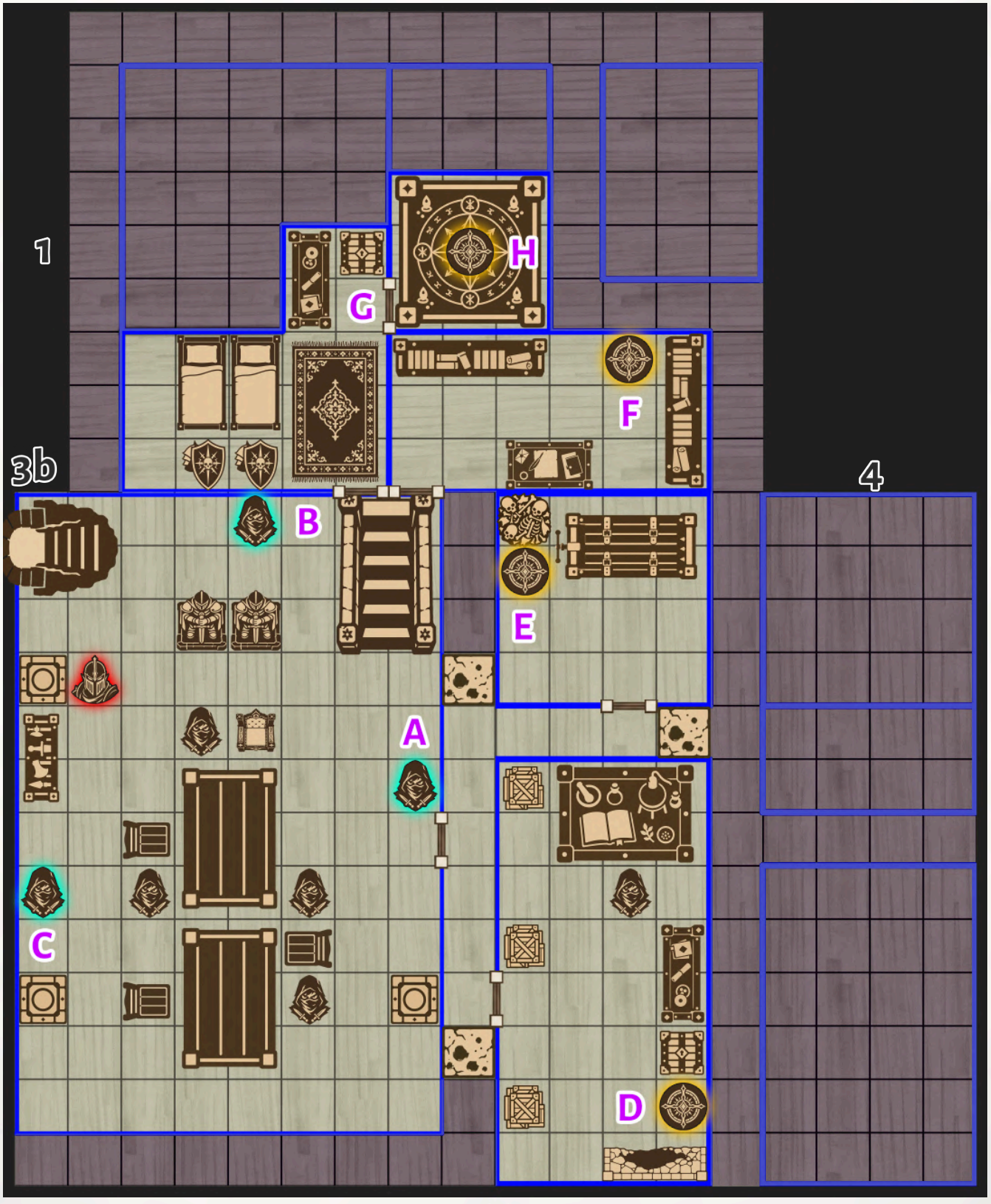
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Adventure 1B: The Baron's Banquet

Starting Doom Clock: 9
Resurrection Boons: 1



Intro

The trouble begins with a sealed letter delivered under cover of night.
It comes from Lady Carvina, a minor noble of Drucavia's court, whose family has long been tied to the estate of Baron Odran Vaal. Her message is careful, but fear stains every line. The baron has changed. His feasts have grown stranger, his servants thinner, and those who speak against him vanish behind locked doors.
Worse still, several nobles who visited his estate have returned with hollow eyes and crueler habits, as if some sickness of the soul now travels from court to court.
Lady Carvina believes Baron Vaal has fallen under demonic influence, or willingly embraced it. Yet accusation without proof would only turn his allies against the crown. Evidence must be found before judgment can fall.
To that end, she has secured your names upon the guest list of the baron's upcoming banquet.

"Go as honored guests," her letter urges. "Smile when they toast, listen when they boast, and search for what he hides. If Baron Vaal is merely corrupt, expose him. If he is something worse, end him before his rot spreads further."
The road leads to Vaal Manor, where music drifts through gilded halls, wine flows too freely, and every locked door seems to breathe.

Objective

Kill Baron Odran Vaal.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	At least 3 clues collected and no more than 1 dead innocent	6	50
★★	At least 1 clue collected and no more than 3 dead innocents	5	45
★	Baron Odran Vaal killed.	4	40

Special Mechanic - Banquet & Games

The characters that are marked down as "Bandits" in the layout represent innocents: nobles, servants and other guests. Use unused hero standees, nobles and peasants to represent them. Each of them has only 1 Health and they do not move unless they are engaged (see below).

The characters next to the labels A, B and C offer various games or interactions that heroes can use to win prizes: but beware, time is limited as the inevitable darkness draws in closer with every minute.

Special Mechanic - Baron Odran Vaal

Baron Odran Vaal, marked as the Fallen Hero in the layout, is initially peaceful. He can be attacked at any time to initiate the fight against him.
Should a hero or minion play a damaging ability or perform an attack while being positioned in the main banquet room (in which Odran Vaal is present), the fight against him also starts. This does not occur when a hero or minion is doing any of these actions in any other room; he just won't hear or see it.

As soon as the Baron fight begins, all other innocents will **Move 2** at the beginning of each round towards the dungeon entrance. If they are already on it, they leave - remove them from the board. Any damage (from enemies or heroes) can kill them, but they are never directly targeted by enemies.

Baron Odran Vaal has the following reference - he is a **boss** and uses the following reference:

Property	Description / Value
Health	45
Defense	4+
Speed	4
Attacks	1
Damage	6
Range	-
Passives	Human, Immune to **Stun, Daze** and **Cripple**.
Traits	Legendary
Minor Ability	**Pesky Demons:** Odran calls pesky little demons to aid him. A hero of the party's choice must roll 1d6 and suffer ... **1-2:** Cripple **3-4:** Daze **5-6:** Stun
Major Ability	***Forbidden Powers*** At the beginning of his turns, roll 1d6 and add the number of already collected clues to the roll. **1-3: Blood Barrage** Odran targets every hero he can see within range 7, causing Blast 3 at their location. Then Odran loses 3 Health. **4: Dark Influence** Odran forces a hero of the party's choice to Move 6 towards any innocent, hero or minion within 6 spaces walking distance and deal 8 damage to them. The hero may choose their target. **5-6: Blood Lance** The furthest hero within range 5 of Odran loses 3 Health. Then Odran loses 3 Health. **7: Evil Whispers** The closest hero within Odran's hearing range must discard one ability. **8+: Backfire** Odran's demonic powers backfire. He loses 5 Health.

Special Mechanic - Guard Spawns

As soon as Odran is openly fighting, at the beginning of each round, roll 1d6 to see which guards spawn on the dungeon entrance to help their baron - if the entrance is occupied, spawn them as close as possible:

- **1-2:** 2 x Corrupted
- **3-4:** 2 x Evil Wizard
- **5-6:** 1 x Living Armor (which represents an Armored Guard, therefore it is Human, not Demon)

Adventure Overview

- A -

This innocent offers a dangerous game of knives. An adjacent hero can spend 2 Stamina to play it. Then roll 1d6 to see the result, and add +1 for every game of knives played by the party before.

- **1-2:** Obtain a Parrying Dagger or - if it's already in play - 20 gold coins.
- **3:** Gain 8 gold coins.
- **4-5:** Gain 5 gold coins.
- **6+:** Lose 1 Health.

- B -

This innocent is an alchemist who is looking for an unsuspecting soul to try his latest experimental concoctions. An adjacent hero can spend 2 Stamina to taste one of his unlabeled potions, roll 1d6.

- **1:** Banish one ability or lose 4 health.
- **2:** Suffer 1 Fatigue.
- **3-4:** Obtain a Healing Potion. If none are available in the item deck, re-roll.
- **5:** Obtain a Rejuvenation Elixir. If none are available in the item deck, re-roll.
- **6:** Obtain a Potion of Clarity. If none are available in the item deck, re-roll.

- C -

This innocent is an enchanter who offers his services. An adjacent hero can spend 2 Stamina to draw three random affixes — **skip** **Mythic** affixes. The hero may then discard one of his items in exchange (except consumables) to apply one of the drawn affixes to an item that that hero still owns. This can be done repeatedly so long as items can be offered.

- D -

The treasure chest here contains **2 x Rations**.

The objective token is a clue and can be collected by spending 1 Stamina. This will weaken and alter Baron Odran's powers (see his reference table). When the clue is collected, spawn **3 x Critter** adjacent to that hero, and read the following aloud:

The kitchen is warm, frantic, and heavy with the smell of over-spiced meat. Half-finished dishes cover every surface, many of them far too lavish for any honest feast. Behind a shelf, you find a bundle of stained delivery notes. They list strange ingredients, rare wines, and sealed packages marked only with a six-winged moth. As you take the papers, something skitters beneath the tables.

- E -

The objective token is a clue and can be collected by spending 1 Stamina. This will weaken and alter Baron Odran's powers (see his reference table). When the clue is collected, spawn a **Fallen Hero** adjacent to the torture rack, and read the following aloud:

The air in this chamber is cold despite the manor's warmth. Rusted tools hang beside the torture rack, and dark stains mark the floor beneath it. Among the scattered instruments, you find a confession signed with a trembling hand. It names Baron Vaal as the host of "private rites" held after each banquet. As you disturb the room, the figure on the rack twitches violently awake.

- F -

The objective token is a clue and can be collected by spending 1 Stamina. This will weaken and alter Baron Odran's powers (see his reference table). When the clue is collected, spawn **2 x Wraith** adjacent to that hero, and read the following aloud:

The library smells of dust, wax, and old perfume. Most of the books are harmless histories and poetry, but one shelf has been locked behind blackened iron. Inside, you find letters, ritual diagrams, and a pressed red flower that has not withered. Several pages mention a hidden patron known only as "the Mother of Want."

The candles gutter. Something in the room has noticed you reading.

- G -

As you enter the bedroom, you hear breathless laughter and the clatter of a goblet falling to the floor.

Stepping further inside, you find two knights tangled in the baron's bed, flushed, intoxicated, and barely aware of your presence. Their armor and weapons lie discarded nearby. They do not seem to mind you intruding, for now.

The door in this room is a secret door that leads to a hidden ritual circle. When opening that door, the two lovers (represented as Blackguards) become agitated. The hero in question may offer any one of their items as a gift to keep them calmed (discard it), but if not, they engage in a fight. Since they are naked, they receive the **Incompetent trait**.

They are not considered innocents for the sake of determining star-results.

The treasure chest here contains 20 gold coins.

- H -

The objective token is a clue and can be collected by spending 1 Stamina.

This will destabilize and alter Baron Odran's powers (see his reference table). Read the following aloud:

The secret door had opened onto a chamber hidden behind the baron's bedchamber. A ritual circle has been painted across the floor in wine, ash, and something darker. At its center lies a sealed letter wrapped in red silk. The wax bears the shape of a six-winged moth.

Whatever Baron Vaal has become, he did not reach this state alone.

Outro

Baron Odran Vaal falls among the ruins of his own feast.

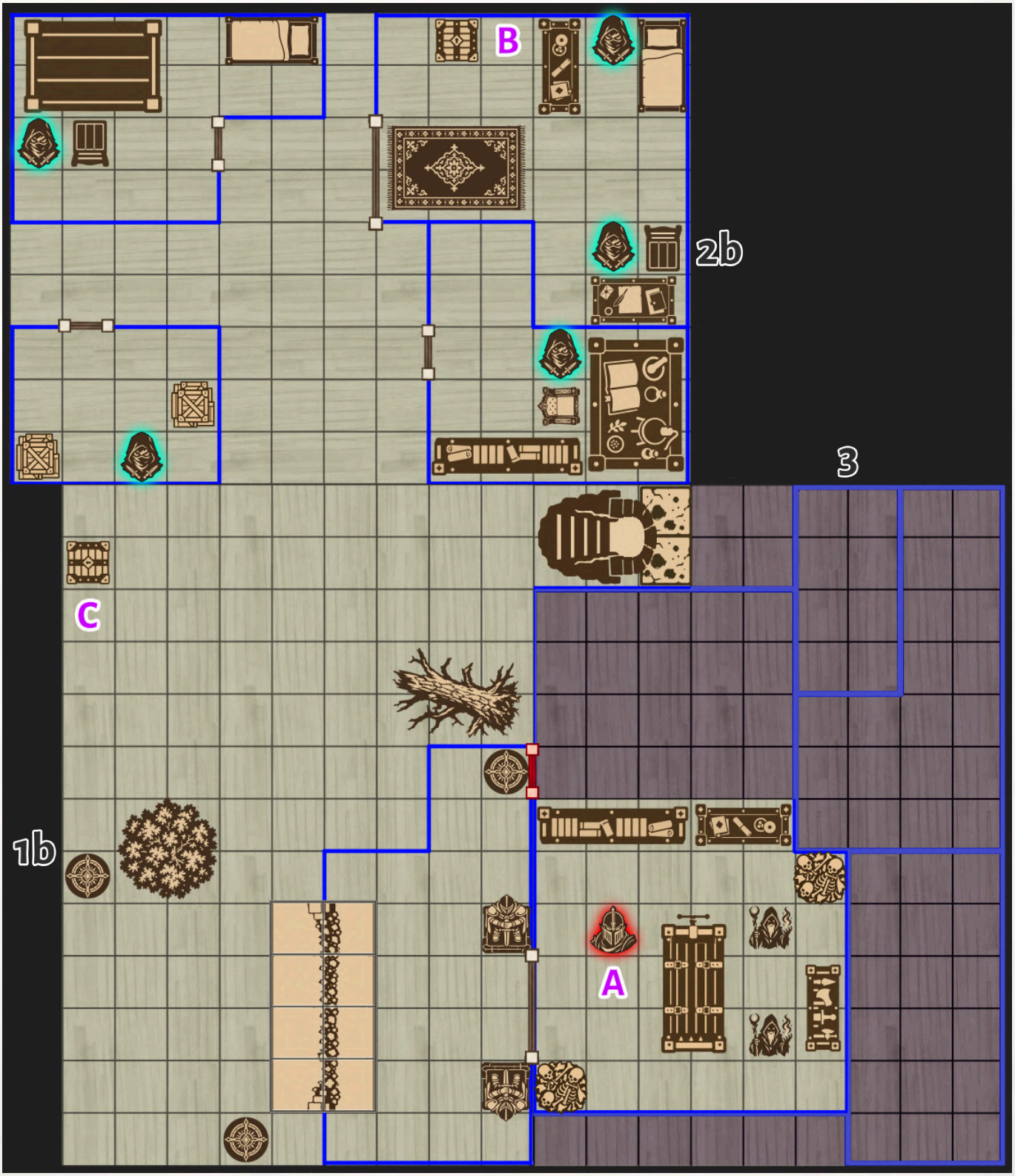
For a moment, the manor is silent except for the crackle of broken lanterns and the groans of the wounded. Then the doors burst open. Servants, guests, and frightened nobles pour in from the courtyard, drawn by the screams and the sudden stillness. Some freeze at the sight of the dead baron. Others begin to weep. A few simply stare, as if waking from a dream they are ashamed to remember. No cheers follow your victory. Only shock, fear, and the bitter smell of spilled wine. When the manor is finally secured, you search Vaal's private chambers. Behind a locked panel in his writing desk, you find a bundle of letters tied with red thread. Most are filled with flattery, threats, and promises of pleasures no mortal court should offer. One letter is different.

Its parchment is thick and pale, its words written in a graceful hand. The wax seal bears the image of a six-winged moth. It invites Baron Vaal to send "worthy guests" to a secluded hunting lodge, where fear is made into sport and obedience is taught beneath golden horns. Lady Carvina's warning was only the beginning.

Whatever corrupted Vaal Manor has already spread to other courts, and the next trail leads to the gilded hunting grounds of Drucavia's nobility.

Adventure 2B: The Gilded Kennels

Starting Doom Clock: 7
Resurrection Boons: 1



Intro

The letters that were recently recovered speak of more than corruption. They speak of sport.
Among the sealed invitations and whispered promises, one trail leads to a noble hunting lodge known as the Gilded Kennels. There, Drucavian nobles gather beneath golden banners to hunt the poor, the indebted, and those no one powerful will miss. Their fear is not merely entertainment. It is tribute, offered to something hidden behind the symbol of the six-winged moth.
Lady Carvina's agents confirm that a new hunt is about to begin. Villagers have already been taken and placed in shacks, where hounds, hunters, and worse things will run them down.
Your task is clear: enter the hunting grounds, protect the prey, and bring as many innocents out alive as you can.

One name appears again and again in the recovered letters: Countess Marvella Thorn. The nobles call her the Mistress of the Hunt. Survivors call her something crueler. It is said she does not merely kill those she catches, but wounds them, toys with them, and lets them run again for the pleasure of watching hope break twice.
Saving the villagers comes first. But if the Countess crosses your path, Drucavia would be cleaner without her.

Objective

Protect the villagers until the noble hunters lose their fervor. The adventure ends when the doom clock hits zero.
Note: Do not increase the doom clock based on previously received campaign quest bonuses, if you have any.

Side Objective

Kill Countess Marvella Thorn.

Starting Condition

The doors that lead to the houses with villagers inside (marked as teal-highlighted bandits) are open from the beginning. Represent the villagers with villager standees or suitable unused hero standees.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	At least 3 villagers survived	5	130
★★	At least 1 villager survived	5	110
★	Adventure completed	3	80

If **Countess Marvella Thorn was killed**, the party may choose one **Mythic** **affix** and assign it to any item they have - this can be done at the end of the town phase to apply it to a just obtained item.

Special Mechanic - The Hunt

At the beginning of each round - including the very first one - roll a d8 to see what kind of hunters appear. Increase the roll by the current count of the doom clock.

- **1-4:** Fallen Hero + 3 x Beast
- **5-7:** Blackguard + 3 x Beast
- **8-10:** 2 x Bandit + 2 x Beast
- **11-13:** Living Armor + 2 x Beast
- **14-15:** 3 x Corrupted + 1 x Beast

As always, if the supply of a given enemy runs out, skip placing additional ones.

After determining which enemies appear, roll a d6 to determine on which objective token they appear - place the enemies on it or as close as possible. The players may decide on the exact formation of enemies placed.

- **1-2:** Objective Token to the west.
- **3-4:** Objective Token to the south.
- **5-6:** Objective Token to the east, close to the entrance of Marvella's Lodge.

Special Mechanic - Hounds & Villagers

The villagers are the ones marked as teal-highlighted bandits on the layout. They have 1 Health and don't move. They cannot be interacted with or affected by abilities.

Beasts always prioritize moving the most efficient route towards the closest villager and then using their attack to kill them. If no villager is adjacent to them after their movement, they will attack a hero or minion if possible.

When a Beast kills a villager, also remove that beast from the board - after all it is busy feasting on the killed villager.

Adventure Overview

- A -

The **boss** in this room is Marvella Thorn. She has the **Enduring, Armored and Counter Attack traits**.

- B -

The treasure chest contains a **random Level 1 item**. Draw items from the item pile until you reveal a Level 1 item, and take that as your reward. You may skip consumables and items worth 10 gold coins or less.

- C -

The treasure contains a random item. Roll 1d6:

- **1-2:** 15 Gold Coins
- **3-5:** 2 Consumables - draw from the item pile until you revealed two.
- **6:** Rapier (Executioner's) or 25 gold coins (choose)

Outro

The hunt ends not with triumph, but with trembling survivors gathered beneath the trees at the edge of the site. Some can barely speak. Others cling to one another, whispering names of those who did not make it out. Yet among the rescued captives, the same phrase returns again and again: the Red Gallery.

They heard of a hidden place where nobles gather behind masks, where demons teach them how to rule without pity, shame, or restraint. Some were meant to be taken there after the hunt, not as guests, but as offerings.

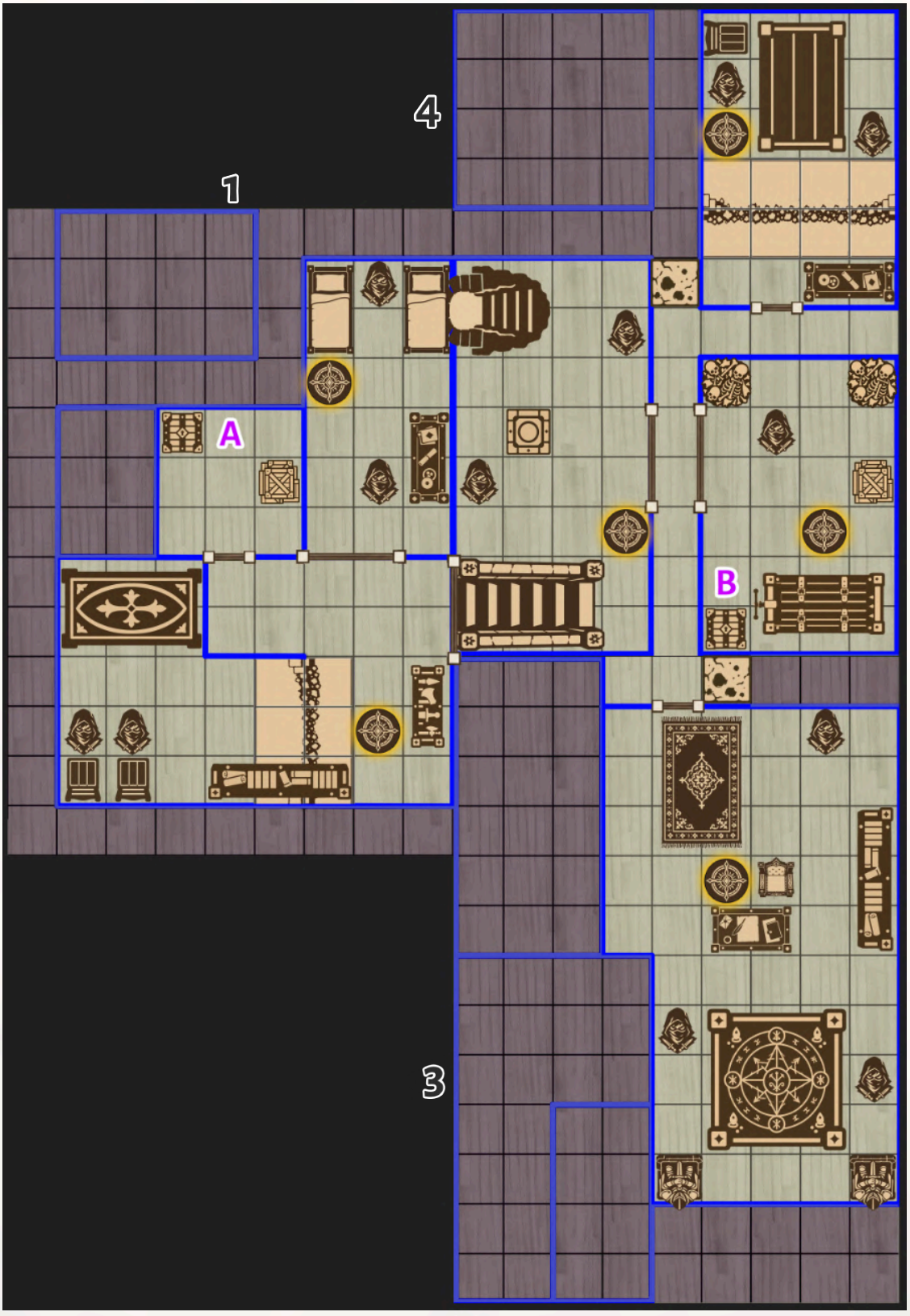
Among the trophies and hunting relics, you find a gilded ritual horn etched with the symbol of a six-winged moth. When touched, it hums with distant music, and for a moment the air ahead shimmers like a doorway behind red glass. The Gilded Kennels were only a threshold.

If the survivors speak true, the horn may open the way to the Red Gallery, where Drucavia's nobility kneels willingly before something far worse than cruelty.



Adventure 3B: The Red Gallery

Starting Doom Clock: 11
Resurrection Boons: 1



Intro

A recently recovered gilded ritual horn does not sound like any mortal instrument.
When blown beneath the moonlight, it gives no clear note. Instead, the air shivers, red curtains appear where none had hung before, and a doorway opens into somewhere hidden beneath Drucavia's noble world.
Survivors called it the Red Gallery: a secret underworld where masked nobles, courtiers, merchants, and oathbreakers gather beyond the reach of law. There, demons do not merely tempt. They instruct. They teach the powerful how to rule without pity, how to turn guilt into appetite, and how to purchase influence with promises no sane soul should make. Lady Carvina believes the Gallery is more than a meeting place. It is a wound in the realm, a place where demonic power is traded one whispered pact at a time.
Your task is to enter the Red Gallery, uncover what bargains are being made, and slay the creature that anchors its influence. Beyond the horn's shimmering passage, music plays from unseen halls, laughter echoes behind velvet masks, and every word carries eerie expectations.

Objective

Expose all demons to lure out Lucilla the Red Muse. Then slay her.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 3+ upon completion	5	140
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion	5	120
★	Adventure completed	4	100

Special Mechanic - Silent Participants

All bandits marked in this quest represent silent bystanders that watch the heroes' steps with eerie eyes. Use any human standee to represent them (e.g. peasants, unused heroes, bandit standees), except the ones used for the mechanic outlined below.

Special Mechanic - The Red Masquerade

Before you begin this adventure, take the following enemy reference cards and put them into one deck:
Blackguard, Evil Wizard, Fallen Hero, Nameless Demon, Living Armor, Succubus

When entering a room with an objective token, that token represents a masked individual. When adjacent, a hero can spend **1 Stamina** to interrogate and look under the mask. Draw one random card of the above enemy cards to determine who was hiding under the mask. If it is a human type, nothing happens for now and you replace the objective token with one model of that enemy group. They remain neutral (for now).

If it is a demon type, place a number of models of that enemy group as close as possible to the objective token as outlined below, and remove the token itself:

Nameless Demon = **x 3**
Living Armor = **x 2**
Succubus = **x 2**

Additionally, **all silent participants** that were in the same room become hostile towards the heroes.

Use the Bandits reference card, and give them the **Sorcerous trait**.

As soon as all three demon types from the face-down enemy deck were discovered and defeated, **Lucilla the Red Muse** becomes aware of the intrusion. Spawn her at the beginning of the next round. Then place her adjacent to the hero furthest from the dungeon entrance.

She is **bespoke boss** and gains the **Protected trait**.

She has two phases with the following boss abilities:

Phase 1
Chain Pull, Twisted Mind, Kiss of the Succubus

Phase 2
Touch of Ruin, Crushing Strike, Call For Aid, Mayhem
Add **Beguiling Command** when playing at **campaign difficulty 4+**.

Adventure Overview

- A -

The treasure chest in this room contains a tome that grants one hero +1 to any one of their ability limits for the rest of the campaign (e.g. Arcane, Combat etc.). Choose the recipient and category during town phase.

- B -

The treasure chest in this room contains a relic: Arcanist's Wand (Spellbound).

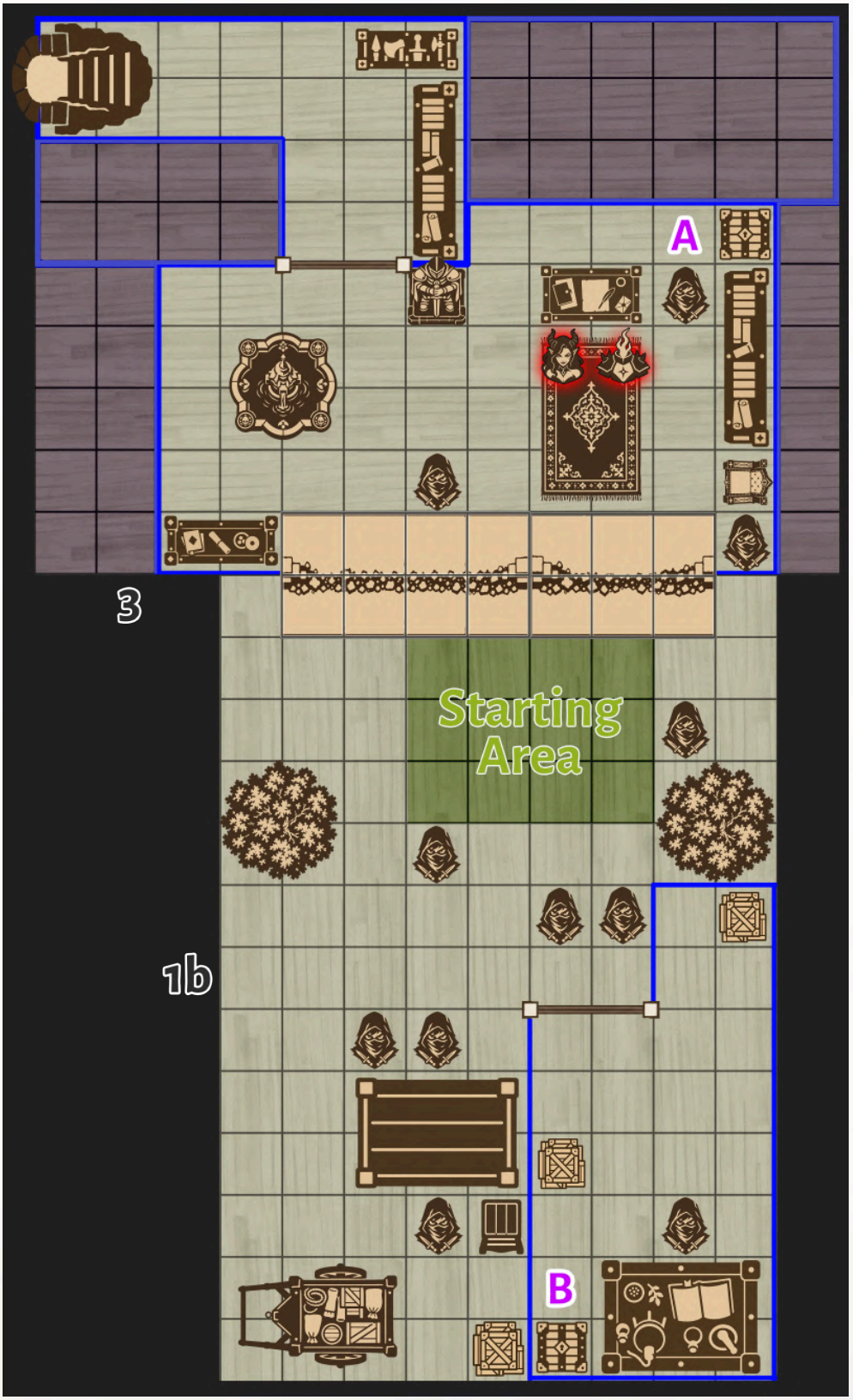
Outro

With Lucilla the Red Muse defeated, the music of the Gallery falters. The laughter fades first, then the whispers, then the soft promises that had seemed to breathe from every velvet wall.
In Lucilla's private chambers, behind curtains of red silk and shelves filled with sealed pacts, you find a mirror unlike the others. Its glass does not reflect the room. Instead, it shows a distant palace built like a cathedral, its halls carved from red marble and draped in black silk.
At the center of that impossible place reclines a horned woman, vast and beautiful, nursing a swarm of winged shadows at her breast. Around her kneel nobles with bowed heads, waiting like children for her attention.
Then her eyes lift toward the mirror. The glass cracks.

Whatever ruled the Red Gallery was only a servant. Somewhere beyond the veil, its Mother waits.

Adventure 4B: The Ashen Dowry

Starting Doom Clock: 6
Resurrection Boons: 2



Intro

A recent vision began to haunt your minds: a cathedral-like palace of red marble and black silk, and at its heart, a horned mother nursing shadows.
Lady Carvina's agents have traced that place to an estate-chapel belonging to one of Drucavia's oldest noble bloodlines. Officially, it is hosting a marriage meant to unite two powerful houses. Unofficially, every name on the guest list appears in records recovered from the Red Gallery.
Once again, Carvina has found you a way inside. Forged invitations, borrowed titles, and a few carefully placed lies carry you through the gates as honored guests. At first glance, the wedding seems almost normal. Musicians play from a marble balcony. Priests whisper blessings. Nobles smile, drink, and applaud as the bride and groom stand before the altar. But the air is wrong.
The guests watch the couple with hungry eyes, and beneath every word spoken in blessing, something older seems to listen. Then the priest raises a silver knife above a black chalice, and the bride smiles as if she has been waiting for this moment all her life.
The time for courtesy is over. Before the silver knife can fall, you cast aside your disguise and strike.

Objective

Kill the bride and the groom.

Starting Conditions

All doors are open from the beginning. Heroes can place themselves anywhere in the starting area.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	6 or more guests slain	5	165
★★	3 or more guests slain	5	140
★	Only bride and groom killed	4	120



Special Mechanic - Bride and Groom

The two quest objectives mark the locations of the bride and the groom. Use the female noble and male noble to represent them. They are both **bosses**.

Jelena The Envious

For **Jelena the Envious**, use the Succubus reference card to represent her stats.
She has **60 Health** and the following traits:

- **Sorcerous**
- **Skilled**
- **Legendary**

Her major ability is overridden by:
Manifested Hysteria - Roll a d6 at the end of her turn, but before Retreat:

1-2: **Painful Shriek** - All heroes in hearing range have to discard one ability.
3-4: **Brutal Outrage** - Move 3 towards a different hero than her initial target and deals 3 damage if they became adjacent. Then repeat this once, but it has to be a target she has not attacked yet.
5-6: **Repeated Stabbing** - Deals four times 2 Damage to the previous target.

If Jelena dies, Roland becomes enraged and uses a forbidden power that turns him into a powerful demon. Then replace his reference card with that of an **Arch Demon**. He gains another **+20 maximum Health** (for a total of **60**).

Roland the Oath-Breaker

For **Roland the Oath-Breaker**, use the Living Armor reference card to represent his stats.
He has **40 Health** and the following traits:

- **Brutal**
- **Powerful**
- **Legendary**

Passively, he is **immune to Daze and Stun**.

His major ability is overridden by:
Royal Knight Training - Roll a d6 at the end of his turn.

1-2: **Kingbreaker Sweep** - Immediately moves the shortest path towards the furthest hero in Range 6. Any hero he was adjacent to during or at the end of this movement is attacked with 4 Damage.
3-4: **Knockout Blow** - If his last attack was successful, the targeted hero now suffers Daze and Stun. Re-roll if the last target was a minion.
5-6: **Ripping Blade** - Immediately performs an attack dealing 5 Damage. If the attack is successful, the hero does not lose any Health, but instead suffers one Injury per 2 points of health they would have otherwise lost, round up. Ignore the Brutal trait for this ability.

If Roland dies, Jelena becomes enraged and uses a forbidden power to activate a devastating aura spell. At the beginning of each round, every hero and minion **loses 2 health**.

Special Mechanic - Doomed Guests

Every model marked as a Bandit in the layout is just a guest - use unused hero standees, evil wizards, fallen heroes and peasants to represent them. They are neutral and don't possess a reference card. Heroes and minions cannot move through them.
At the end of each round, every guest will first make a desperate attack against an adjacent hero, dealing **2 damage** (the party may choose the target). Then they **Move 3** towards the dungeon entrance.
If they are already on it, they escape and are removed from the board.
Each guest has **defense 3+** and **3 health**. The heroes can slay them to improve the adventure rewards!

Special Mechanic - Guards!

At the beginning of each round, spawn 2 Bandits on the dungeon entrance which represent soldiers coming to the aid bride and groom.
If the supply is too limited and it is not possible to spawn both Bandits, spawn 1 Blackguard instead.
Do not spawn these in the very first round, and stop spawning these as soon as the Doom Clock reaches 0.

Adventure Overview

- A -

This treasure chest contains 35 gold coins.

- B -

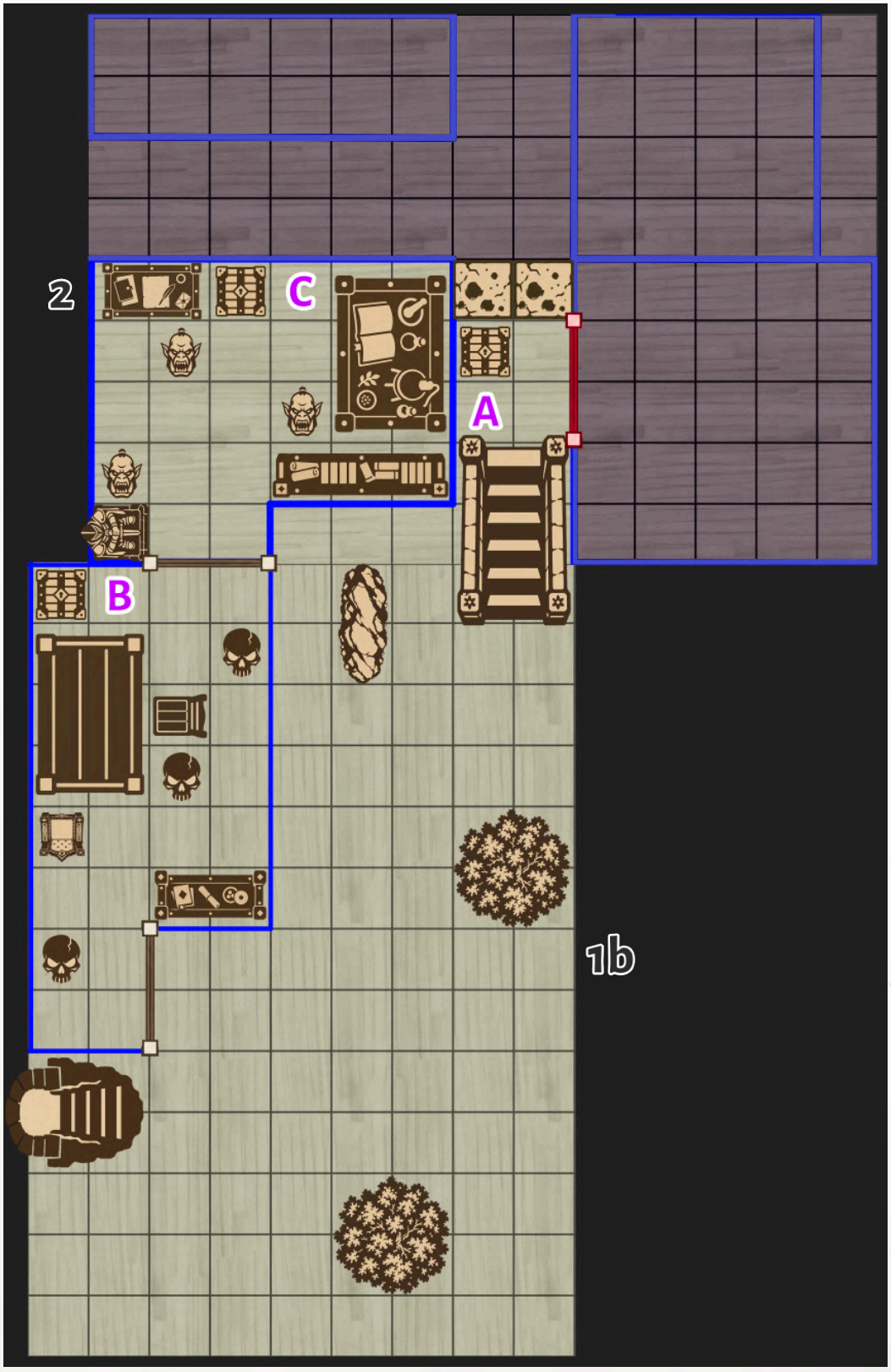
This treasure chest contains a random level 3 item. Draw items from the pile until a level 3 item is revealed, then take it. You may skip consumables. Afterwards, shuffle the item pile.

Outro

The bride and groom fall beside the shattered altar, their vows ending in blood and silence. With the last of their strength, they crawl toward one another across the red marble. Their hands almost meet before both go still.
Among the dowry gifts, you find a blackened chest bound in silver wire. Inside rests an ashen heart, dry and cracked, yet pulsing faintly as if it remembers life.
The moment one of you looks upon it, something presses into your mind.
Visions flash behind your eyes: masked nobles kneeling in candlelit halls, red fruit hanging from dead trees, winged shadows circling above a ruined castle. Beneath it all, a vast hunger stirs, ancient and patient.
Then one place rises clearer than the rest: the Orchards of Saint Corda.
Every royal map marks them as abandoned. Every court record says nothing remains there. The heart pulses once more. Something waits among the trees.

Adventure 5B: Orchards of Saint Corda

Starting Doom Clock: 10
Resurrection Boons: 2



Intro

The royal maps name the Orchards of Saint Corda as abandoned, forgotten, and empty. They lied.

Beyond the broken pilgrim gate, the old orchard still grows beneath a colorless sky. Its trees are impossible things, their black roots coiling through prayer stones and buried bones. Blossoms open and wither in the span of a breath. Branches bend beneath fruit that should not exist: pale, red, golden, and ash-grey, each one swelling, ripening, and falling in unnatural time. When the fruits strike the ground, they do not split, but whisper.
They promise strength. Relief. Purpose. They call to old wounds and secret hungers, each voice soft enough to mistake for your own thoughts. For a moment, all else is still. Only the trees, listening.

Then a door bursts open somewhere beyond the orchard rows.
Corrupted nobles spill into the clearing in silks and rusted finery, their faces twisted with outrage. Demons move among them like cursed family. To them, you are not intruders in an abandoned place. You are defilers of a holy site. With shrieks of devotion and hunger, they charge.

Objective

Survive the waves of enemies.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Ate 6 or more Demon Fruits, or no hero ever died (even if resurrected).	3*	160
★★	Ate 4 or more Demon Fruits, or a maximum of 1 hero died (even if resurrected).	3*	140
★	Adventure completed	3*	130

* Additional experience points can be gained during the adventure from Demon Fruits.

Special Mechanic - Corrupted Onslaught

Take the following enemy reference cards and shuffle them into a pile:
Bandit, Beast, Blackguard, Corrupted, Evil Wizard, Fallen Hero, Nameless Demon, Succubus, Living Armor, Wraith

At the beginning of each round, including the first, draw 2 random enemy cards and spawn a number of models based on its type adjacent to the red locked door. Place them as close as possible.
If there were already 3 or more enemy groups active, draw only 1 card instead.

The adventure ends when all cards were drawn and all remaining enemies are defeated.

Enemy	# of Models
Bandit	4
Blackguard	2
Evil Wizard	4
Nameless Demon	3
Living Armor	3

Enemy	# of Models
Beast	4
Corrupted	4
Fallen Hero	2
Succubus	2
Wraith	4

Special Mechanic - Forbidden Fruits

At the beginning of each round, the party may place an objective token adjacent to any of the two trees. If four tokens are already on the board, do not place additional ones.
While being adjacent to such a token, a hero can spend 1 Stamina to eat a forbidden demon fruit. Remove the token, then that hero gains **+1 XP** (to a maximum of 2 XP per hero during this adventure), and chooses one benefit based on the type of forbidden demon fruit they ate:

Moon Fruit: Rest 1, then Surge 6.
Blood Apple: Heal 5 and Treat 1.
Ashen Pear: Regain 5 abilities or regain 1 banished ability.
Saint's Fig: Add +1d8 to all attack, spellcasting and defense rolls you make during this round.

After consuming the fruit, **reduce the Doom Clock by 1 step**! If it was already at 0, every hero has to banish one ability as per usual.
Remember to track the total number of Demon Fruits consumed for the reward assessment at the end.

Adventure Overview

- A -

The treasure chest contains a random **Epic** affix.
Draw from the pile of affixes until you have two. Then choose one of the two affixes to apply it to an item of the party's choice.

- B -

The treasure chest contains two consumables. Draw cards from the pile until you have two consumables.

- C -

The door opens onto a ruined study. Alchemical glass is shattered across the floor, and a corrupted wizard lies torn apart among spilled powders and bloody parchment.
Several orcs rummage through the wreckage, searching with grim purpose. Then one turns toward you.
Its eyes are dead. Its wounds hang open, bloodless and old. The others rise with the same dragging motion, their bodies moved by something buried deeper than thought.

The Orcs in this room have the **Zombies trait**.

The treasure chest here contains a tome that grants one hero +1 to any one of their ability limits for the rest of the campaign (e.g. Arcane, Combat etc.). Choose the recipient and category during town phase.

Outro

At last, the orchard falls silent.

The corrupted nobles lie scattered among the roots, their silks torn and darkened by mud. The demons that guarded this place are gone, leaving only the bitter scent of ash, sap, and spoiled sweetness. Above you, the impossible fruits shrivel on the branches. One by one, they fall and split open, their whispers fading into wet, broken sounds. Yet the oldest tree still stands.

Its trunk is vast and black with age, wrapped in dead prayer ribbons and the remnants of offerings left by hands long turned to dust. Beneath its roots, half-buried in the earth, you find a sealed casket of tarnished silver. Inside rests a confession, written by a queen of Drucavia that died years ago.

Her words speak of bargains made in hunger, of feasts that never ended, and of a motherly thing that offered love only to devour it. At the end, one paragraph is written with shaking certainty:

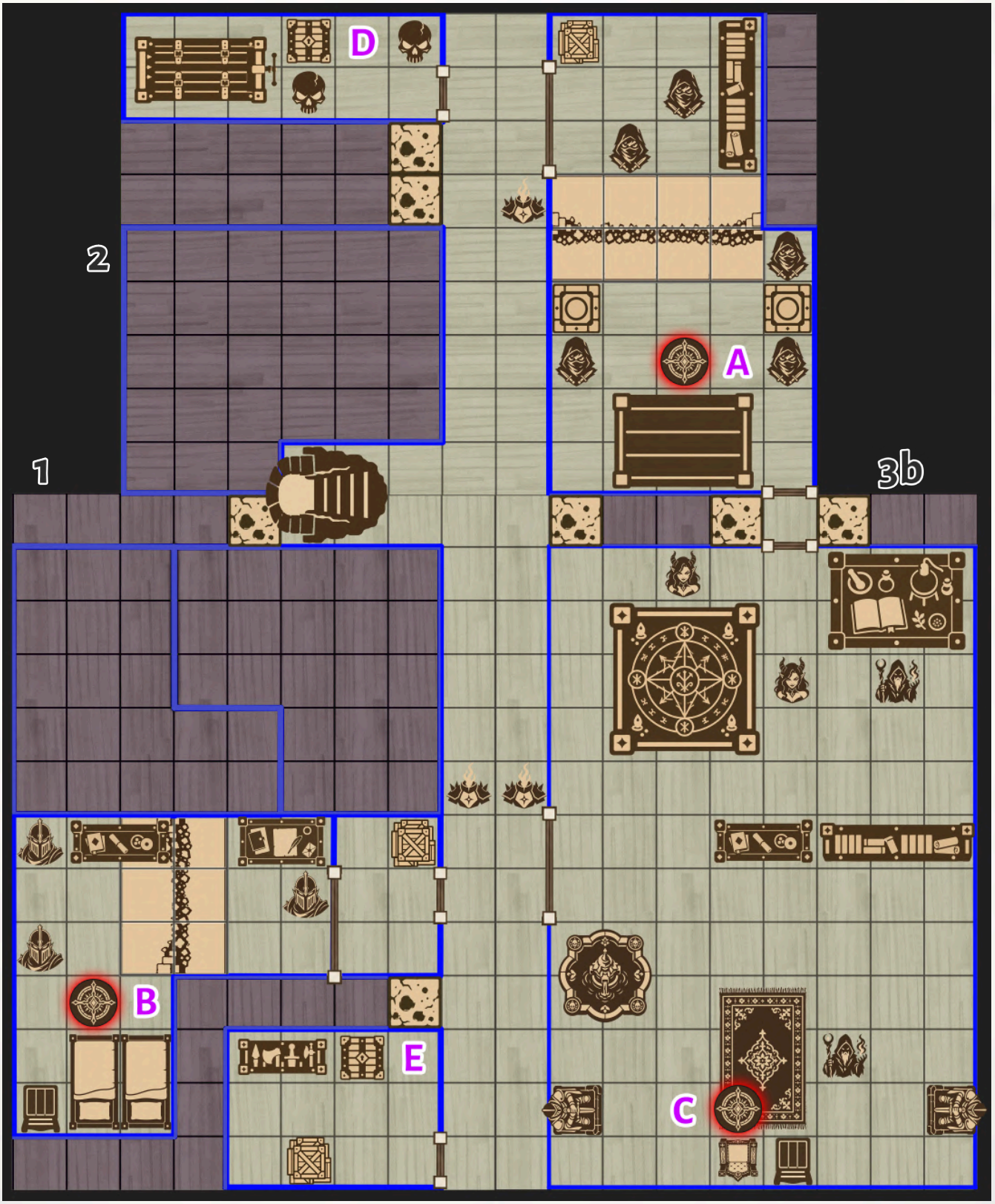
The Palace of the First Feast - the Mother's true refuge. The orchard was not her throne. It was only her garden!

On the back of the confession, a rough map has been drawn in faded ink. One place is circled near the northern borders of Connidge, its marking pressed so deeply into the parchment that the quill nearly tore through.



Adventure 6B: Palace Of The First Feast

Starting Doom Clock: 10
Resurrection Boons: 1



Intro

A recently recovered map leads you beyond the last honest road, to a palace hidden among black cypresses and pale stone terraces. Its gates stand open before you, tall and silent, as if they have been waiting.
Inside, the air is warm, sweet, and rotten beneath the sweetness. Candles burn with steady crimson flames. Marble corridors gleam as if freshly washed, yet every reflection seems a breath too slow to follow your movements. Servants drift through the halls in fine livery, heads bowed and faces carefully empty. They do not raise weapons. They do not cry for help. One of them simply steps aside and whispers, "Honored guests. The feast has not yet ended." No alarm is sounded as you enter deeper into the Palace of the First Feast, and no door is barred against you. Whatever rules this place does not fear your arrival.
It has made room at the table.

Objective

Kill the three lieutenants of the Mother: The Duke Of Coins, The Lustful Duchess and the Chain Marquis.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion, and no hero died (even if resurrected)	5	190
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion	4	160
★	Adventure completed	4	120

Special Mechanic - Sin Unbound

The three lieutenants of the Mother that guard this place are embodiments of three sins: Greed, Lust and Dominion. The very same that corrupted Drucavia's nobility over the last few years.
When a lieutenant is defeated, the sin itself is released and will affect the heroes until the end of the adventure while they attempt to hunt down the remaining lieutenants.
The specific effects that come into play are described with each lieutenant. It is recommended to read them in advance to strategically choose the order in which they are hunted down.

Adventure Overview

- A -

Here is the **Duke of Coins,** using the following reference - he is a **boss**.
Use the Blackguard standee to represent him.

Property	Description / Value
Health	35
Defense	5+
Speed	4
Attacks	1
Damage	8
Range	-
Passives	Human, Immune to **Daze & Cripple**.
Traits	Legendary
Minor Ability	**Throwing Coins:** At the start of his turn, the Duke throws a bag of heavy coins at the closest hero within range 4. They lose 2 Health and suffer Daze & Stun. The party gains 5 gold coins.
Major Ability	***The Duke's Cursed Ledger*** At the end of his turns, roll 1d6. **1-2: Blood Tithe** The party must lose 5 gold coins. If they cannot or choose not to, all heroes lose 1 Health. **3-4: Coin of Promise** The Duke cannot be attacked or damaged by heroes / minions any longer. From now on, heroes can attack each other - assume a base defense of 4+. As soon as a total of 6 damage have been dealt against each other among heroes and minions, the curse ends. **5-6: Paid Protection** Immediately spawn 2 Living Armors adjacent to the Duke.

Greed Unbound - When the Duke of Coins is defeated, his sin becomes unbound. At the end of each round, one hero must discard 1 consumable or the party must spend 5 gold coins. If they cannot or choose not to, each hero suffers 1 Fatigue.

- B -

Here is the **Lustful Duchess,** using the following reference - she is a **boss**.
Use the Noble (female) standee to represent her.

Property	Description / Value
Health	55
Defense	3+
Speed	4
Attacks	1
Damage	7
Range	-
Passives	Human, **Reach,** Immune to **Daze & Cripple**.
Traits	Legendary, Cowardly
Minor Ability	**Come Closer:** At the start of her turn, the furthest hero within Hearing Range must move up to 5 spaces toward the Duchess. If they end adjacent to her, they suffer Daze and receive a bonus attack of 4 Damage. It does not count against her Attack limit.
Major Ability	***The Duchess' Invitation*** At the end of her turns, but before Retreat, roll 1d6. **1-2: Jealous Glance** Choose two heroes that have Line of Sight to each other. One hero Heals 2, the other suffers 2 Fatigue. Then both suffer Stun. **3-4: Soft Command** The hero with the most abilities in hand must banish 1 ability. Heroes adjacent to them must discard 1 ability. **5-6: Paralyzing Kiss** The Duchess performs a bonus attack dealing 5 damage against an adjacent hero (does not count against her attack limit). If the attack is successful, that hero suffers Daze, Cripple, Stun and Decay 2.

Lust Unbound - When the Lustful Duchess is defeated, her sin becomes unbound. After the Stamina checks each round, roll 1d6 and choose one hero:

- **1-2:** **Lustful Thoughts:** The hero discards 1 ability, or 2 if adjacent to another hero.
- **3-4:** **Succumbing Body:** Lose 2 Stamina. If adjacent to another hero, both lose 1 Stamina instead.
- **5-6:** **Ecstasy:** One hero may Move 1 to become adjacent to another hero. They then both suffer Daze and 1 Fatigue, but gain Heal 2 instead. If they did not become adjacent, the hero that was chosen originally cannot perform anything this round.

- C -

Here is the **Chain Marquis,** using the following reference - he is a **boss**.
Use the Noble (male) standee to represent him.

Property	Description / Value
Health	40
Defense	4+
Speed	5
Attacks	1
Damage	6
Range	-
Passives	Human, Immune to **Daze & Cripple**.
Traits	Legendary, Counter Attack, Tough to Kill
Minor Ability	**Kneel:** At the start of his turn, the closest hero within range 4 suffers Cripple.
Major Ability	***Edicts of the Chain Marquis*** At the end of his turns, roll 1d6. **1-2: Bound By Law** Until the end of the Marquis' next turn, heroes cannot Dodge or Block. **3-4: Punish Defiance** Distribute a total of 6 Health Loss among all heroes within the Marquis' hearing range. Every hero who loses at least 1 Health also loses 1 Stamina. **5-6: Chained Souls** The Marquis performs Retreat 4. With every step taken, every hero and minion must move 1 space towards the Marquis. At the end, the Marquis performs Blast 2.

Dominion Unbound - When the Chain Marquis is defeated, his sin becomes unbound. At the end of each round, if the party did not Daze, Stun or Cripple at least one enemy this round, each hero loses 1 health.

- D -

This treasure chest contains 35 gold coins.

- E -

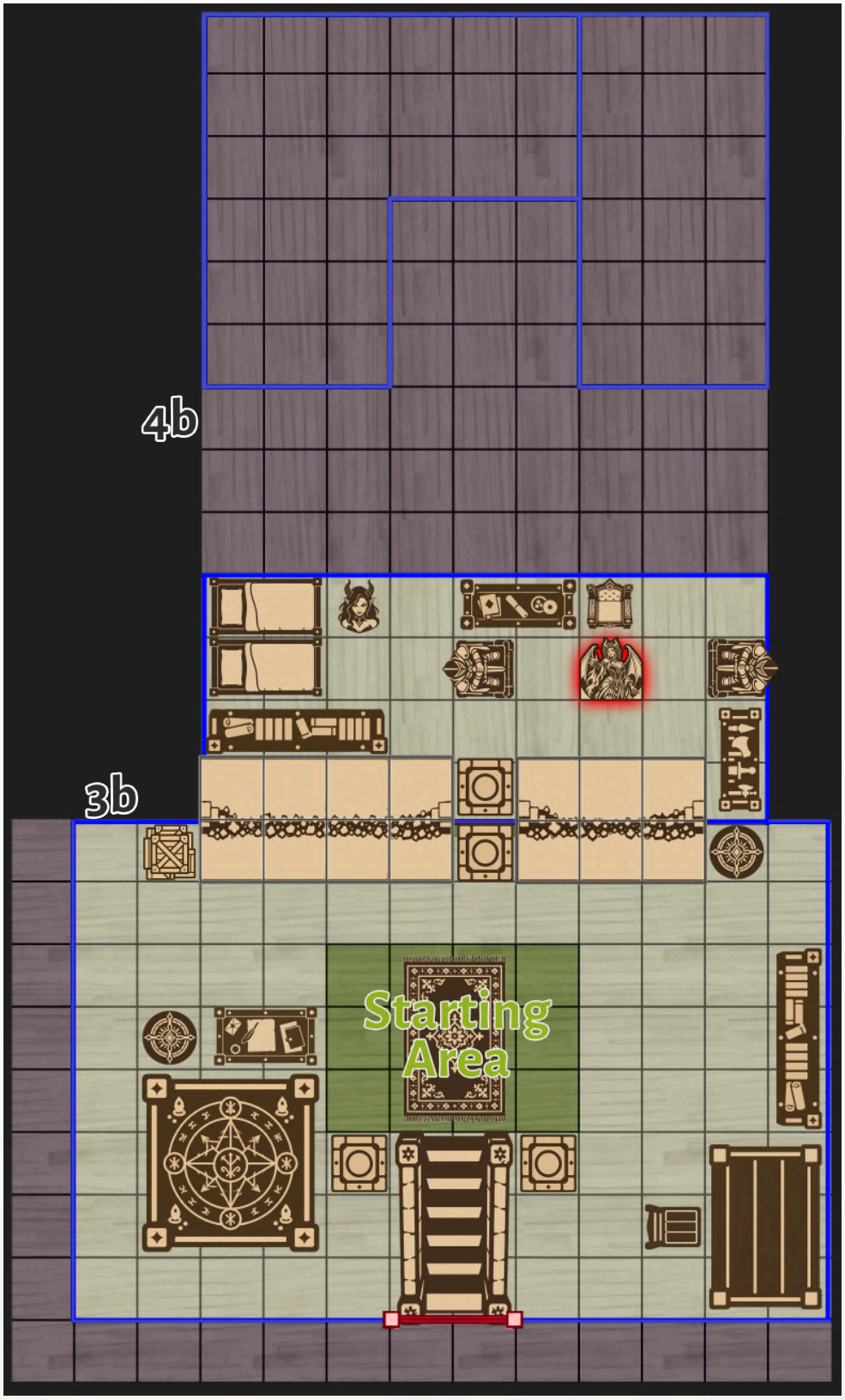
This treasure chest contains a relic: Rapier (Executioner's, Honed, Stalwart)

Outro

The last of the three lieutenants falls, and with them the palace seems to exhale. Then, somewhere above, servants begin to weep without knowing why.
From deep below the palace, a shriek tears through the stone: not grief, but pain and fury. Something vast has felt the loss. You follow the sound down winding stairs, past wine cellars gone sour and locked doors that open at your touch. At the lowest chamber, the air itself is split open. A portal shimmers between two pillars of black marble, its surface rippling like velvet beneath unseen fingers. Beyond it waits no earthly room.
Only darkness, warmth, and a hunger that knows your names.

Adventure 7B: The Velvet Abyss

Starting Doom Clock: 2*
Resurrection Boons: 2



Intro

The portal waits in the cellar like an open wound, breathing crimson light into the dark.
Beyond it lies a vast hall of black marble and red silk, suspended in endless shadow. Chandeliers burn above without chains. Pale servants bow in silence as you pass.
At the far end, whispering hearts beat around a throne of gold, bone, and blooming flesh.
Sunetha, the Mother of Want, rises to greet you. Her smile is soft. Her shadow is not.
"My poor little heroes," she whispers. "You have taken so much from me."
The hearts beat faster.
"Now show me what you still desire badly enough to kill for."

Objective

Kill Sunetha, the Mother of Want.

Starting Conditions

The players can place themselves anywhere in the starting area when the adventure begins.
The red locked door is the portal entrance and will be used as the "Dungeon Entrance" to determine the activation order of enemies.

Place Sunetha, The Mother Of Want, and one initial Succubus as indicated.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	No more than 2 Whispering Hearts were silenced.	-	-
★★	No more than 3 Whispering Hearts were silenced.	-	-
★	Sunetha successfully slain.	-	-

This adventure grants no rewards, as the campaign ends and the heroes retire afterwards.
Star results are only relevant for the Legacy Sheet.
Remember the one-time star bonus upon completing the campaign equal to difficulty x 3.

Special Mechanic - The Want Clock

The Doom Clock functions differently during this adventure.
It starts at 2 and **increases** by +2 at the beginning of each round, except for the first.

Special Mechanic - Ensorcelling & Fervor

When Sunetha ensorcels a hero (see her major ability), that hero gains a number of Fervor tokens equal to the current level of the Doom Clock - use Daze tokens or similar and place them on the hero reference card on the initiative track to represent them.
An ensorcelled hero cannot negatively affect any enemies. They cannot positively affect other heroes or minions either. By all intents and purposes they now fight on the side of the enemies.

The player still takes their turns as per usual and the party can agree on the initiative order as before.

Note: The **"Protective" affix** cannot prevent the ensorcelling, as it is a special mechanic and not an ability. The player has to attack their former allies to lose Fervor tokens. Every point of damage dealt, even if it was mitigated, removes one token. If the damage results in health loss, or health loss is otherwise caused, remove an additional Fervor token each. If other heroes damage the ensorcelled hero, the same rules apply. For attacks against heroes, assume a defense of 4+.

As soon as all Fervor tokens are lost, Sunetha immediately **loses 3 health** and the hero can continue their turn normally - they are not considered ensorcelled any longer.

Special Mechanic - Whispering Hearts

The objective tokens in the layout represent Whispering Hearts.

A hero adjacent to one can spend 1 Stamina to silence and destroy it. When this happens, **cut the current Doom Clock in half** (then round up), but Sunetha immediately performs a bonus attack as revenge!



Special Mechanic - Sunetha, the Mother of Want

Sunetha is a **bespoke boss** who gains the **Protected and Legendary traits**.

She has two phases with the following boss abilities:

Phase 1

Kiss of the Succubus, Touch of Ruin, Crushing Strike, Dark Aura

Phase 2

Puppet, Whispers of a Succubus, Injuring Stab, Combo
Add **Mayhem** when playing at **campaign difficulty 4+**.

Various events happen depending on the number of wounds she has taken (the number of ability cards banished from suffering damage).

Any enemies spawned this way appear as close as possible to the red locked door.

2 Wounds	Spawn 3 Nameless Demons.
3 Wounds	Spawn 1 Arch Demon. Also spawn 2 new Whispering Hearts. The heroes can place them anywhere on the board, but they must at least be 5 spaces walking distance apart from each other, and each of them must be 3 spaces walking distance away from Sunetha.
4 Wounds	Spawn 3 Fallen Heroes.
5 Wounds	Spawn 2 Succubi.

Outro

Sunetha's smile breaks before the rest of her does.
The whispering hearts burst one by one, spilling crimson light across the black marble. The velvet dark recoils, folding inward like a curtain pulled from the world. For one breath, every remaining servant in the hall is silent.
Then the Mother of Want collapses into ash, gold, and a cloud of perfume.
The palace trembles. Its servants fall to their knees, not in worship, but release. Somewhere beyond the throne, a door appears where no door had been before.
Cold mortal air seeps through its cracks. A way home.

Campaign End + Seraphim Unlock

You have finished this campaign. Check which campaign quests you completed and gain their rewards for future campaign playthroughs.
Additionally, if this is the first time you have slain Sunetha, the Mother of Want, read the following text aloud:
Next to the throne, chains of black gold bind a winged figure to the stone.
With Sunetha dead, the chains crack. One by one, they fall away, and pale radiance spills through the hall.
A seraphim lifts her head. "For an age, I sang beneath her hunger," she whispers. "Now I may remember the sky."
She spreads her wings, and the last shadows of the Velvet Abyss fade away in her divine light.

Unlock the class **"Seraphim"** for all future playthroughs.